

2.0

Brand control

2.1

Brands are systems of control

Brands control messages that enable organisations to establish themselves as unique and distinctive players in a particular marketplace.

Brands allow organisations to communicate messages quickly and effectively by combining visual, verbal and environmental information, including logotypes and images. In this way **brands transcend verbal language barriers** and can quickly connect with audiences both globally and locally.

To be effective, **brands must be unique** within their sector. **Brands must be applied consistently and systematically** so that their messages penetrate and stick. If brands are too varied, or if they keep changing, audiences will not ‘see’ them.

It takes time to build a brand and for audiences to become familiar with a brand. This means doing and saying the same things over and over again. Brands build relationships with their audiences over time, and they can be quickly ‘broken’ if they appear to be uncontrolled. Excessive variations or changes can cause audiences to lose trust in brands and to doubt the integrity and stability of organisations. **Brands must be controlled if they are to be effective.**

Brand leadership sits with the Board and Senior Leadership Team (SLT) at Kingston University. The Board, as the primary strategic decision-making body within the University, has oversight of all

aspects of the University’s business and brand – visually, verbally and environmentally. This is supported by the SLT and led by the Brand, Communications and Public Affairs function which has responsibility for maintaining the brand strategy and for its development and implementation.

Brand resources and archive

The Brand, Communications and Public Affairs team maintains current versions of the Brand Guidance, which is regularly updated. Find the most up-to-date version on our Brand SharePoint homepage.

The University is a big institution that is constantly changing, so please help us by making the Brand, Communications and Public Affairs team aware of your needs if these are not currently covered. This will ensure the Brand Guidance is relevant, comprehensive and up-to-date.

Brand support

If you require further guidance and support, or if you have a specific requirement not covered in the Brand Guidance, you can access help at:

corporatecommunications@kingston.ac.uk

2.2

Brand inspiration, photography, copy, digital files, advice and support

Brand inspiration

The Brand, Communications and Public Affairs function maintains an archive of recently completed outputs including exhibitions and publications, presentations, signage, environmental graphics, social media and much more. These are available to use as design references.

If you require further information or would like advice about a communications project, or need support with key messages for awards submissions please contact

corporatecommunications@kingston.ac.uk

If you need support with images or digital files. Contact: **D.Wood@kingston.ac.uk**

Brand photography

The University maintains a database of photography that is licensed for use.

Copyright theft is a crime so please use photography that is licensed and approved by the Brand, Communications and Public Affairs function.

Guidance regarding commissioning new photography and videography can be found in Section 4.9 of this document.

Brand copy

Our brand narrative and key messages can be found in sections 3.3 – 3.4 and can be downloaded from our Brand SharePoint page. This will save time and effort and will ensure that all verbal communications about the University are consistent and reinforce our unique proposition within the higher education sector.